

**The tool is just the
hammer.**
The platform is the house.

Build with AI speed. Govern with enterprise confidence.

The Innovative Maker is the **game changer**.

Business Innovators start in **vibe.powerapps.com** — describe an idea, ship a working app. Pro Developers ship in **VS Code + GitHub Copilot** with full CI/CD. In between sits the persona that breaks the old ceiling: the **Innovative Maker**, who fluidly moves between **vibe.powerapps.com** and VS Code — *given incredible AI superpowers, but contained and controlled by the platform.*

The Innovative Maker is the Game Changer.

Contained, controlled superpowers — the cross-over between idea and code.



Microsoft Power Platform — One Solution • One Dataverse • One Governance Model • Same Artifact at Every Stage



Managed Environments
Secure, isolated, and scalable.



DLP
Data protection policies built-in.



Entra ID
Identity, roles, MFA, access control.



Audit
Field-level audit, history, and logs.



ALM
Git integration, pipelines, DevOps.

Business Innovators ideate • Innovative Makers cross over • Pro Developers harden • Power Platform governs every stage.

1

IDEATE & BUILD

Business Innovator

vibe.powerapps.com

- ✓ Describe the idea in natural language
- ✓ AI builds the first working app
- ✓ Validate with real users in days
- ✓ Hand off — or keep going

★ GAME CHANGER

2 CROSS-OVER · CONTAINED SUPERPOWERS

Innovative Maker

vibe.powerapps.com and VS Code + GitHub Copilot

- ✓ Starts in vibe.powerapps.com *or* VS Code — whichever fits the task
- ✓ Pulls Code Apps into VS Code when vibe hits a ceiling — and keeps building from there
- ✓ Uses GitHub Copilot Agent Mode to extend, refactor, and harden at AI speed
- ✓ Guardrails via `copilot-instructions.md` and `AGENTS.md`
- ✓ **Same artifact, same Dataverse, same governance — either way**

3 HARDEN & SCALE

Pro Developer

VS Code + GitHub + ALM

- ✓ Custom components, integrations, complex logic
- ✓ Source control, code review, CI/CD pipelines
- ✓ Performance, security, observability
- ✓ Ship to Managed Environments with confidence

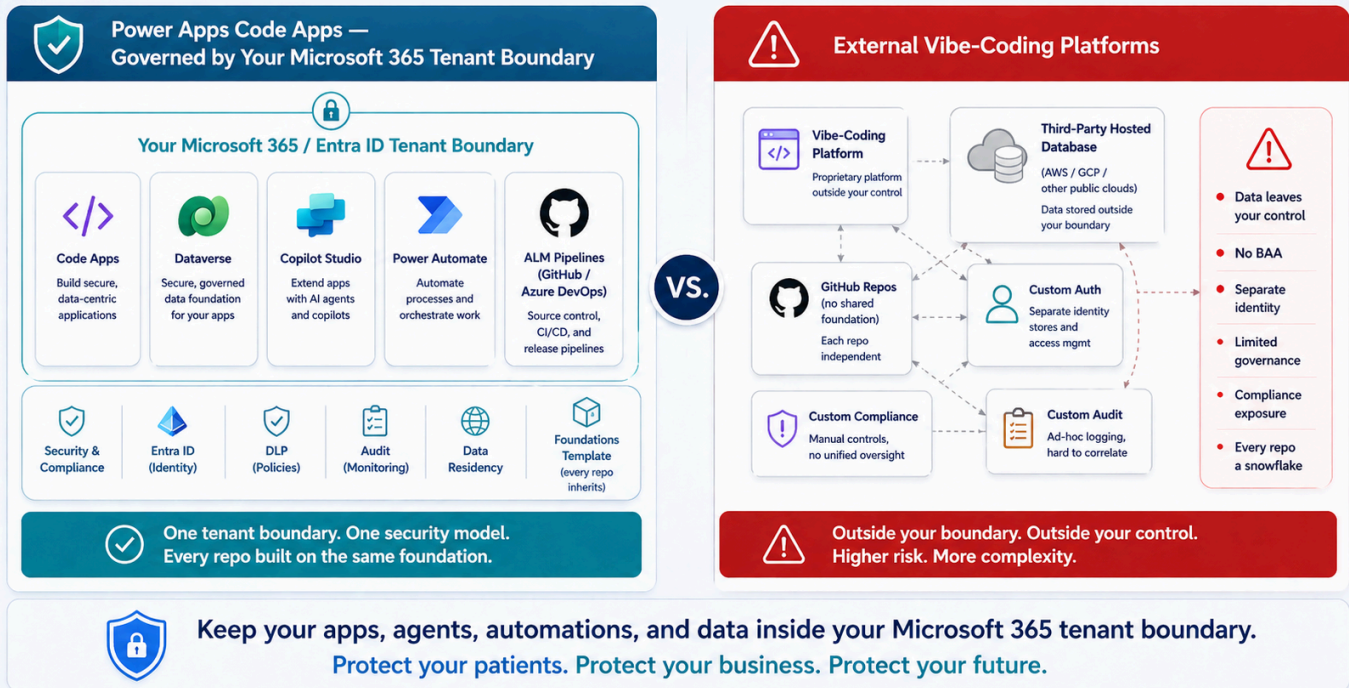
These are roles, not necessarily different people. Often a Business Innovator *becomes* the Innovative Maker the moment vibe hits its limit — and the platform makes that step continuous instead of a cliff. The Pro Developer joins when CI/CD, custom components, or hardening matter. Same solution, same Dataverse, same governance throughout — **that's what makes the cross-over safe.**

Configure once. Let 1,000 makers self-serve.

Admins configure ALM pipelines and **Managed Environments** once. After that, makers ship to dev → test → prod with proper promotion, DLP, and approval gates baked in.

Architectural Comparison: Two Approaches.

Build on your platform. Keep your data inside your boundary. Stay in control.



Architectural comparison — build on your platform, keep your data inside your tenant boundary, stay in control.

✓ Code Apps + Managed Environments

- ✓ One-time admin setup of pipelines, DLP, and environment groups
- ✓ Makers self-serve deployments — guardrails enforced automatically
- ✓ **Every repo inherits the same governed foundation** — instructions, ALM, security, tests, agent guardrails — from a versioned template (see [Chapter 10](#))
- ✓ Update the foundation once → every downstream repo can pull it in
- ✓ Solution packaging carries data model + UI + logic together
- ✓ Tenant-wide audit, telemetry, and CoE visibility across the fleet



External Vibe Platforms — Repos Without a Foundation

- × **Every repo starts from scratch** — no inherited instructions, no inherited ALM, no inherited tests
- × Governance must be re-invented per repo, per team
- × Each external data backend (hosted Postgres, Firebase, Supabase, etc.) is its own snowflake
- × No tenant-wide DLP, no native solution packaging, no way to push a fix across the fleet
- × **Estimated +1.5 to +2.5 FTEs** of platform/governance overhead at scale (illustrative, varies by org)

The problem isn't repo count — Code Apps create plenty of repos too. The problem is repos that don't inherit a common foundation.

This is not a feature comparison. It is a boundary.

For any organization handling PHI, this single chapter ends the conversation. It's a contractual and regulatory boundary — not a preference.

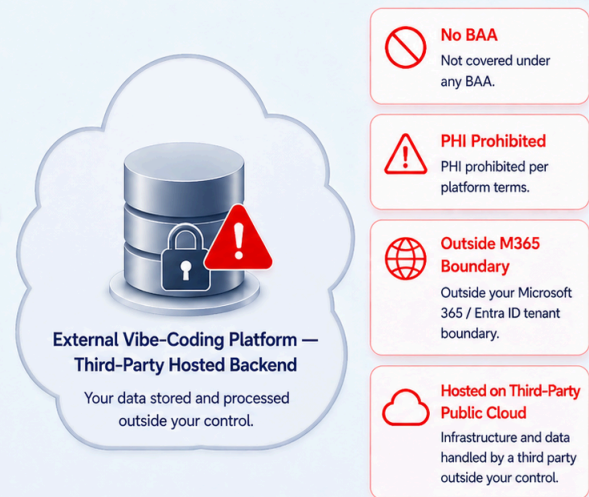
INSIDE YOUR TENANT BOUNDARY

Your data stays governed, protected, and under your control.



OUTSIDE YOUR TENANT BOUNDARY

Data leaves your control and enters a third-party environment.



VS.



Many vibe-coding platforms' own published terms explicitly prohibit PHI and other regulated data. Always verify the legal posture of any platform you evaluate.

Data must stay inside your tenant boundary — protect patient data, preserve compliance, maintain trust.



Inside the Fence

CODE APPS WITH DATAVERSE

- ✓ Microsoft-operated SaaS governed by your **Microsoft 365 / Entra ID tenant boundary**, with regional data residency
- ✓ Covered by a **signed Microsoft BAA**
- ✓ PHI, PII, and regulated workloads explicitly supported
- ✓ FedRAMP High and HITRUST attestations apply on the Microsoft commercial cloud; sovereign-cloud options (GCC, GCC High, DoD) available — verify Code Apps availability in your target cloud
- ✓ Field-level audit and change tracking native to Dataverse; integrated with Microsoft Purview eDiscovery



Outside the Boundary

EXTERNAL VIBE-CODING PLATFORMS

- × Default data layer is a **third-party hosted backend** (hosted Postgres, Firebase, Supabase, etc.) on a public cloud you don't control — outside your Microsoft 365 tenant boundary
- × No Microsoft BAA coverage
- × Many of these platforms' **own published terms explicitly prohibit PHI** — see proof drawer below for one transparent example
- × Cannot be easily relocated into a customer-controlled Microsoft cloud boundary

This pattern is common across the category. We use **Lovable** here as a representative example because their terms are particularly explicit. Replit, Bolt, v0, and similar platforms typically carry comparable restrictions in their own published terms — always verify the current legal documents of any platform you evaluate.

TERMS & CONDITIONS [lovable.dev/terms \(https://lovable.dev/terms\)](https://lovable.dev/terms)

*"You agree not to upload, input, or otherwise provide any **protected health information under HIPAA**, or any other sensitive categories of data... Our Services are **not designed to handle that type of data**, and we disclaim all responsibility if you choose to submit it."*

DATA PROCESSING AGREEMENT · §8

[lovable.dev/data-processing-agreement \(https://lovable.dev/data-processing-agreement\)](https://lovable.dev/data-processing-agreement)

*"The Customer shall **not provide any data to Lovable which is classified as sensitive**. For the avoidance of doubt, the Customer agrees not to upload... any **protected health information under HIPAA**..."*

PRIVACY POLICY [lovable.dev/privacy \(https://lovable.dev/privacy\)](https://lovable.dev/privacy)

Explicitly warns against uploading sensitive health data.

KEY TAKEAWAY FOR HEALTHCARE & LIFE SCIENCES

Microsoft signs a BAA and keeps your data inside your Microsoft 365 tenant boundary. The **external vibe-coding category, broadly, does not** — and many of these platforms explicitly prohibit PHI in their own published terms. Always confirm the legal posture of any platform before letting regulated data near it.



One intelligent connection for agents.

In the era of intelligent agents, the data layer must speak the agent's language. Many databases now ship MCP servers — including Azure SQL, Cosmos DB, and Postgres — but they expose *schema*. **Dataverse's MCP exposes business semantics:** security roles, business units, business rules, choice sets, relationships, and audit — the things agents actually need to act safely on enterprise data.

DATAVERSE

Total context. One connection.

- ✓ Auto-discover tables, columns, relationships
- ✓ Row & column security flow through
- ✓ Business rules & choice sets introspectable
- ✓ Copilot Studio, M365 Copilot, custom agents

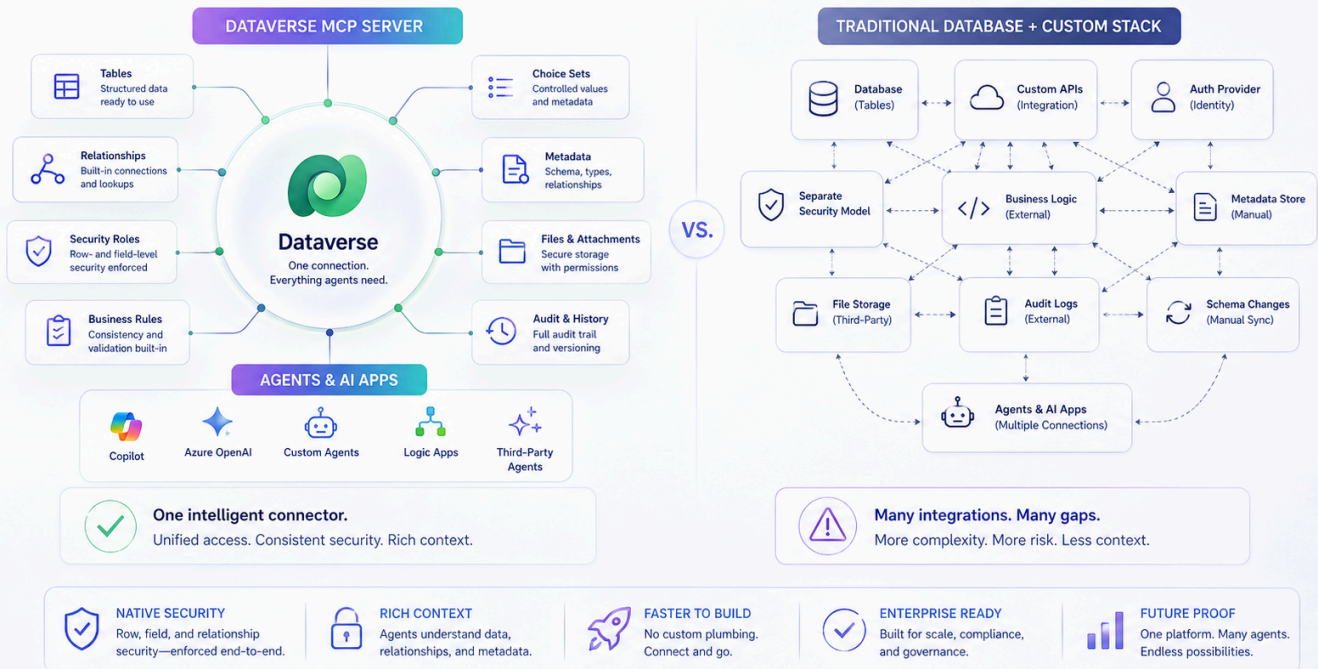
SCHEMA-ONLY MCP

Plumbing without meaning.

- ✗ MCP exposes columns and types, not business rules or security roles
- ✗ Row/column security must be re-described to every agent
- ✗ Constant drift between schema, prompts, and policy
- ✗ Each new agent restarts the integration cost

Dataverse: One Intelligent Connection for Agents

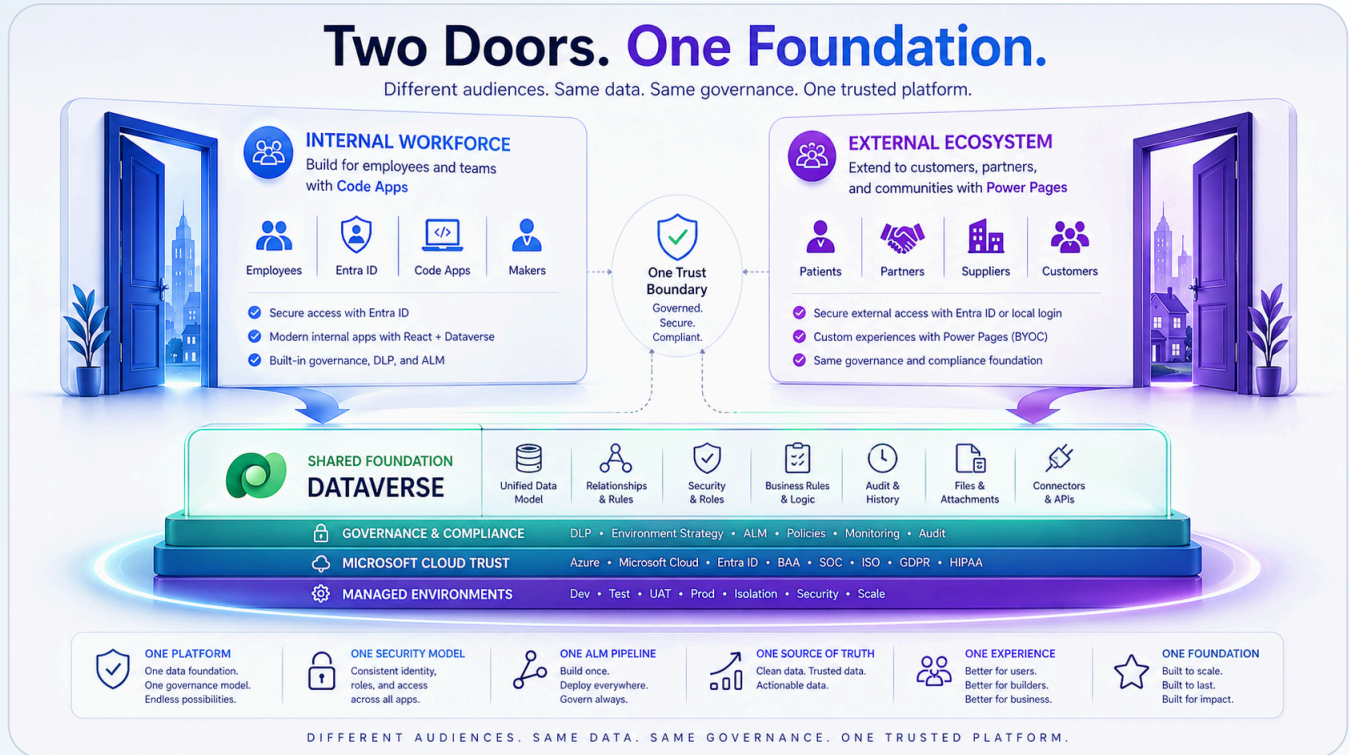
Expose data, relationships, and security to agents—natively and securely.



Dataverse exposes tables, relationships, metadata, security, and business rules — natively to agents.

Two Doors. One Foundation.

Different audiences. Same data. Same governance. One trusted platform.



Internal Workforce

CODE APPS · ENTRA ID

- ✓ Modern internal apps with React + Dataverse
- ✓ Secure access with Entra ID
- ✓ Built-in governance, DLP, and ALM



External Ecosystem

POWER PAGES · BYOC

- ✓ Customers, patients, partners, suppliers
- ✓ Modern React on the secure Power Pages runtime
- ✓ Same Dataverse security, end-to-end

ONE PLATFORM

One data foundation

ONE SECURITY

Identity, roles, access

ONE ALM

Build once. Govern always.

ONE TRUTH

Clean, trusted data

ONE EXPERIENCE

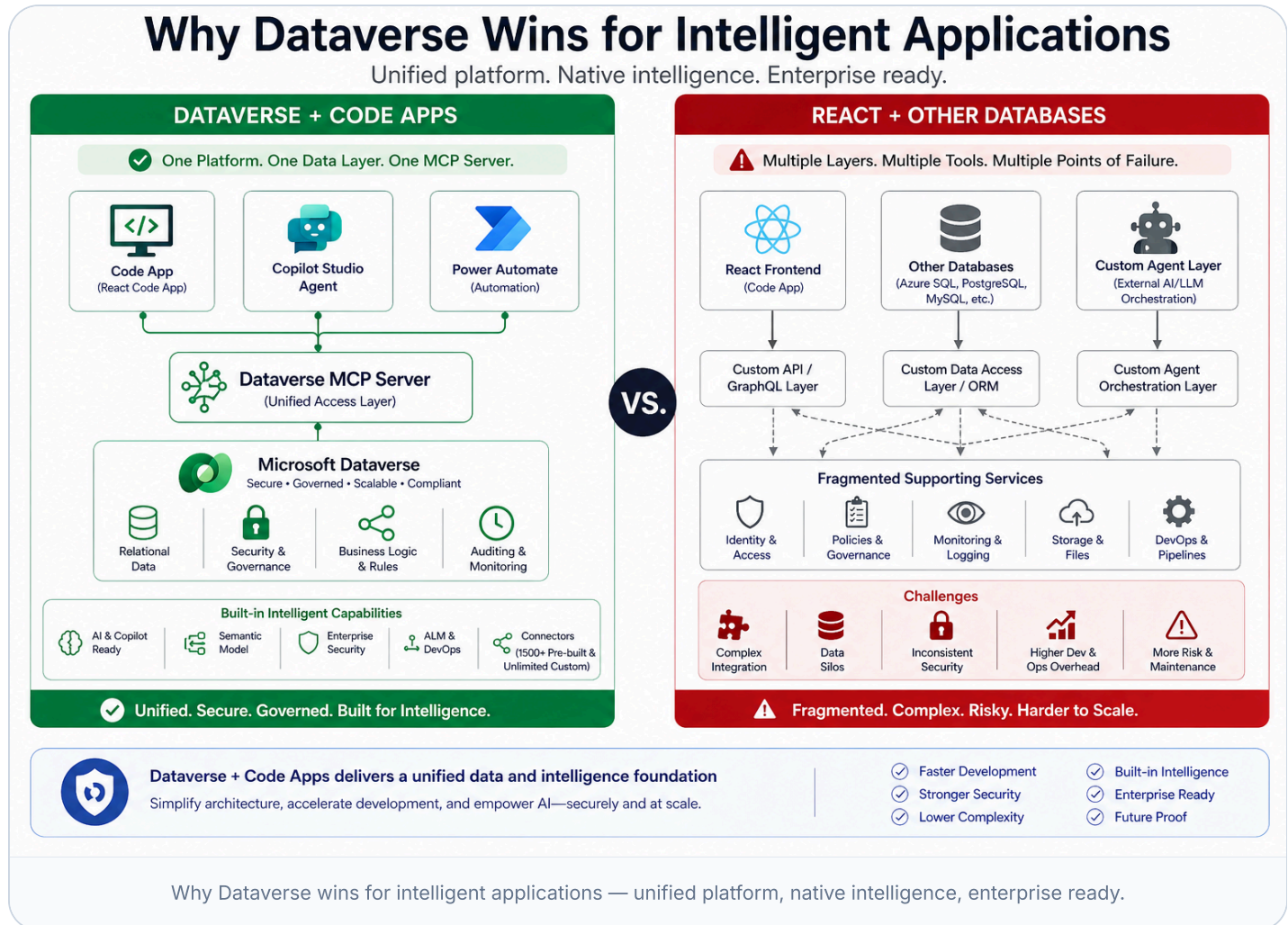
Users · Builders · Business

ONE FOUNDATION

Built to scale & last

A traditional database is just a database. Dataverse is a platform.

Dataverse is a governed business application platform. The difference shows up in nearly every dimension that matters at enterprise scale.



CAPABILITY	DATAVERSE	OTHER DATABASES
Row & column security	✓ Built-in security roles, business units, hierarchical, field-level	✗ Custom-built with views, RLS policies, and app-tier code
MCP Server	✓ Native — exposes business semantics: security roles, business	✗ Where MCP exists, exposes <i>schema only</i> — security and

	rules, choice sets, relationships, audit	business rules must be re-described per agent
Agent intelligence	✓ Copilot Studio + M365 Copilot speak Dataverse natively	✗ Requires bespoke prompt engineering and middleware
Business logic location	✓ Centralized: business rules, plug-ins, flows	✗ Scattered across app code, stored procs, triggers, services
ALM & solution packaging	✓ First-class solutions carry schema + UI + logic together	✗ DACPAC + custom scripts + bespoke release pipelines
Show 4 more rows ▼		

The hidden cost of tool sprawl.

Simplicity drives value. Complexity drives cost, risk, and time.

We deliberately don't put dollar signs here — pricing varies by scale, region, and deal. The point is the **shape** of the cost structure.

True Total Cost of Ownership

5-Year Cost Complexity Comparison (Example)



Simplicity drives value. Complexity drives cost, risk, and time.



Power Platform Code Apps

Integrated. Predictable. Included.

What You Pay For
Few Components. One Bill.



Power Platform

Platform, services, security, governance, and support all included.



GitHub Enterprise

Source control, collaboration, security, and DevOps integrated.

Cost Characteristics



Predictable
Clear licensing and usage



Unified Support
One vendor. One contract.



Built-In Governance
Security, compliance and DLP included



Lower Complexity
Fewer moving parts to manage



Fewer moving parts. Easier to budget. Easier to manage.



Lovable Approach

Multiple Components. Multiple Vendors. Multiple Costs.

What You Pay For
Many Components. Many Bills.



Lovable Platform
Platform access and usage



Supabase Hosting
Database, storage, compute, backups, bandwidth



GitHub Enterprise
Source control, collaboration, security, DevOps



Extra Governance & Support
Policies, monitoring, access reviews, incident response



Compliance & Risk Mgmt.
Audits, assessments, risk mitigation, documentation

Cost Characteristics



Complex
Many components and dependencies



Multiple Vendors
Multiple contracts, renewals, and SLAs



Higher Risk
More integration and compliance exposure



More Effort
More setup, management, and upkeep



Less Predictable
Usage, pricing, and change variability



More moving parts. Harder to budget. Harder to manage.



Bottom Line

Power Platform Code Apps combine world-class capabilities with enterprise-grade controls in a predictable, all-in-one model—reducing total cost complexity and operational burden.



One Platform. Fewer Moving Parts. Greater Value.

True total cost of ownership — simplicity drives value, complexity drives cost, risk, and time.

POWER PLATFORM CODE APPS

Integrated. Predictable. Included.

What you pay for: Few components. One bill.



Power Platform

Platform, services, security, governance, support — all included



GitHub Enterprise

Source control, collaboration, security, DevOps

Predictable

Clear licensing

Unified Support

One vendor

Built-in Governance

Compliance & ALM

Future-Compatible

Fewer parts

EXTERNAL VIBE PLATFORM APPROACH

Many components. Many bills.

What you pay for: Many components. Many bills.

VP

Vibe-Coding Platform

Subscription, usage, compute, backups

DB

Third-Party Data Backend

Hosted database on AWS / GCP / other public clouds — storage, networking

GH

GitHub Enterprise

Repos, security, governance, DevOps

+G

Extra Governance & Support

Policies, monitoring, incident response, added FTEs

C&R

Compliance & Risk Mgmt

Audit, logging, certifications, documentation

Complex

Multiple bills

Higher Risk

More integration surface

Reduced Reliability

Less consistency

Higher Maintenance

Vendor sprawl



BOTTOM LINE

One platform. Fewer moving parts. Greater value.

Bring any frontier model. Always know which one you're using.

Coding-model leadership shifts month to month. The **VS Code ecosystem** — GitHub Copilot for first-party Microsoft-supported models, plus Cursor, Cline, and other agent tools for the broader frontier — lets developers pick the model by name and version, and swap the moment a stronger one ships. With most external vibe-coding platforms, the model is opaque.

Below: a cross-section of leading coding models available across the VS Code ecosystem in 2026. Availability inside GitHub Copilot itself varies by model and changes over time — check the current [GitHub Copilot documentation \(https://docs.github.com/en/copilot\)](https://docs.github.com/en/copilot) for the live list.

ANTHROPIC

Claude Opus 4.x

Sonnet 4.x · Haiku 4.5

Industry-leading agentic coding & long-horizon refactors.

OPENAI

GPT-5 / GPT-5 Codex

o-series reasoning

Strong general coding & deep reasoning workflows.

GOOGLE

Gemini 2.5 Pro

Gemini Code Assist

Massive context windows for whole-repo reasoning.

GITHUB

GitHub Copilot

Multi-model: Claude · GPT · Gemini

One subscription, you choose the brain per task.

CURSOR

Cursor + Composer

Routes to Claude / GPT / Gemini

IDE-native agent loops, model of your choice.

XAI

Grok Code

Grok 4 family

Real-time web context for current API knowledge.

DEEPSEEK

DeepSeek-Coder V3

Open-weights option

Strong code completion at lower cost-per-token.

ALIBABA

Qwen Coder

Open-weights, multilingual

Self-hostable for sovereign workloads.

The cadence is the point: new frontier coding models drop every few weeks. Within **days to weeks** of release, they typically appear in at least one VS Code-compatible surface — GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Cline, or direct API integrations. Yesterday's leader rarely stays the leader for long — and your developers will always know which one they're running.

Code Apps — Open & Transparent

- ✓ **Named, versioned models** — you always know what wrote your code
- ✓ Any model in VS Code or GitHub Copilot works here
- ✓ Switch per repo, per developer, per task — even per file
- ✓ GitHub Enterprise controls keys, models, audit, policies
- ✓ `copilot-instructions.md` sets guardrails across every assistant
- ✓ New frontier model today → available within days

External Vibe Platforms — Opaque Models

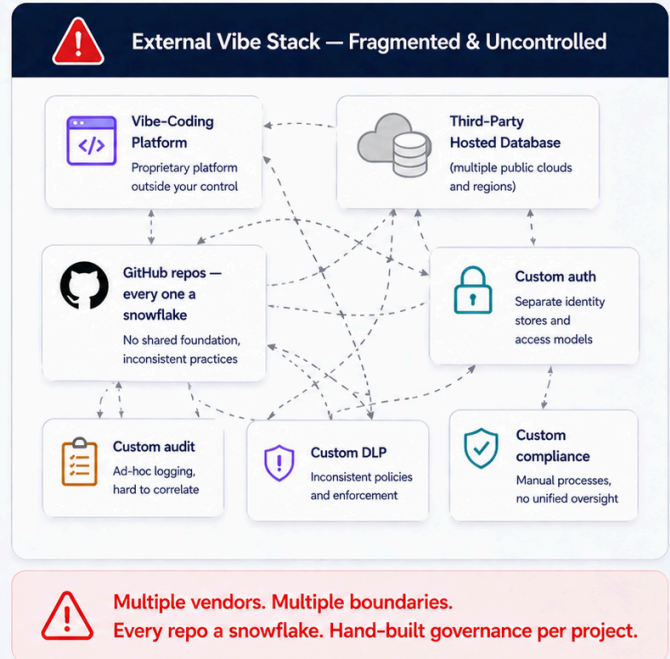
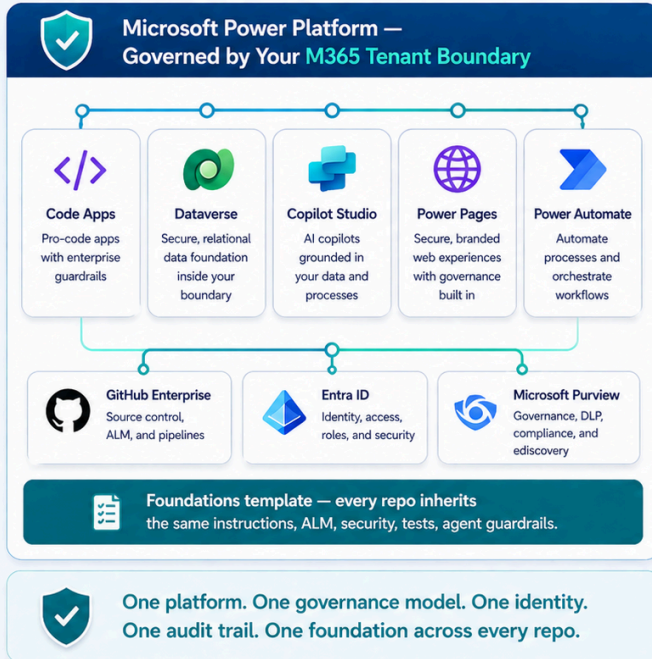
- ✗ **No model transparency** — you don't know which model or version
- ✗ Cannot verify whether you're on the latest frontier capability
- ✗ The platform vendor decides the model roster — switching is not yours
- ✗ No version history, no audit trail of which model produced what
- ✗ Enterprise key management lives outside customer control
- ✗ In a landscape that shifts weekly, opacity is a liability

CHAPTER 09 · THE BIGGER PICTURE

Fragmentation feels fast at first. Platform coherence wins at scale.

One Platform. One Foundation. Total Control.

Unified under your Microsoft 365 tenant boundary vs. fragmented across external boundaries.



Unified platform vs fragmented tools — connected, governed, reliable, built to scale.

Getting started is the hardest part — until now.

Most teams spend their first month discovering platform quirks the hard way.

PAppsCAFoundations encodes every one of those lessons into a repeatable, tested path — so your team builds features on day one, not debugs platform quirks.

Your Path to Success with Power Apps Code Apps

A proven foundation. A clear path. Faster to value.



Getting Started is the Hardest Part...



- ✗ Too many decisions
- ✗ Scattered setup steps
- ✗ Inconsistent patterns
- ✗ Wasted time
- ✗ Higher risk

5 Deploy to Production
Ship with speed.
Operate with trust.



4 Integrate Agents & ALM
Add intelligence, automate
delivery, govern with confidence



**3 Scaffold React +
Dataverse App**
Production-ready code,
connected to Dataverse



2 Run the Setup Wizard
One click to configure
your environment



**1 Plan with
Copilot Instructions**
Define your app, data,
and business goals with AI



FOUNDATION STONE
PAppsCAFoundations

<https://aka.ms/codeappsfoundations>

...But Now There's a Clear Path!



- ✓ Clear, proven path
- ✓ Best practices built-in
- ✓ Faster development
- ✓ Lower risk
- ✓ Business impact, faster



Start Strong. Build Smart. Deliver Impact.

PAppsCAFoundations gets you from zero to production—fast.



Accelerate Delivery

Get to production
faster



Built on Best Practices

Enterprise-ready
from day one



Secure & Governed

Built-in security
and governance



Scale with Confidence

Designed to grow
with your business

PAppsCAFoundations — a proven foundation, a clear path, faster to value.



Consulting-Grade Methodology

Business decomposition → scope refinement → Dataverse planning → prototype validation → build & deploy.
Encoded in your repo.



Agent-Guided Development

14 scoped instruction files plus `AGENTS.md` — Copilot, Cursor, Claude Code, every agent follows the same rules.



Interactive Setup Wizard

A 9-step wizard verifies prerequisites, scaffolds React + Fluent UI + Dataverse, seeds prototype assets, runs smoke tests.



Testable from Day One

Vitest, Playwright, MSW ship in the scaffold. Smoke tests pass on first run. Mocks let you test before Dataverse exists.



Security-First Auth

1Password CLI integration or AES-256-GCM encrypted secrets. Pre-commit hooks block accidental secret commits.



Foundations Sync

Pull the latest instructions, scripts, and wizard into your downstream project. No fork management. No merge conflicts.

OPEN SOURCE · MIT LICENSED

Start strong. Build smart. Deliver impact.

Clone the template, run the wizard, start building. Your team gets the accumulated lessons of every team that came before.

Open Repo → (<https://github.com/martycarreras-psnl/PAppsCAFoundations>)

See Setup Path (<https://martycarreras-psnl.github.io/PAppsCAFoundations/guide.html>)

Start Building (<https://aka.ms/codeappsfoundations>)

If you're building serious enterprise applications, platforms win.

Build with AI speed. Govern with enterprise confidence.

Choose Code Apps when you value:

- ✓ Tenant-resident, BAA-covered data (PHI, PII, regulated)
- ✓ A maturity model from citizen to pro developer
- ✓ Native MCP and agent intelligence
- ✓ Configure-once governance for 1,000+ makers
- ✓ External-facing apps via Power Pages BYOC
- ✓ Freedom to use any frontier AI model in VS Code

Reconsider external vendor platforms when:

- ✗ PHI or other regulated data is in scope
- ✗ You need tenant-wide governance and ALM
- ✗ Repos that don't inherit a common foundation become unmanageable
- ✗ Agent integration is a strategic priority
- ✗ Long-term maintainability matters more than first-week velocity

"The AI coding tool is just the hammer. The platform is the house."

For organizations that value governance, compliance, agent integration, long-term maintainability, and the ability to scale citizen development safely — **especially when PHI is involved** — Power Apps Code Apps with Dataverse is the clear, defensible enterprise choice.

DISCLAIMER

This content is **not a formal statement, position, or endorsement from Microsoft**. It is an observational perspective from **Marty Carreras** (<https://www.linkedin.com/in/carrema/>), Microsoft's US Healthcare & Life Sciences AI Business Process and Workforce CTO, offered to help organizations think through enterprise application strategy. Opinions are the author's own.

Power Apps Code Apps Advantage · Build with AI speed. Govern with enterprise confidence.